

# mPDF

## A zero-width space in core fonts

This document is written with the PDF core fonts, whose windows-1252 encoding has no code for a zero-width space (U+200B). Every sample holds at least one. None of them may draw a question mark or any gap of its own, and where a line has to break, it breaks at the zero-width space rather than in the middle of a word.

### Two long words

Two 60-letter words joined by a zero-width space, in a box 40mm wide. The first word fills three lines and the second starts on a line of its own.

```
abcdefghijklabcdefghijkl  
defghijklabcdefghijkl  
hijklabcdefghijkl  
abcdefghijklabcdefghijkl  
defghijklabcdefghijkl  
hijklabcdefghijkl
```

### A path with a break after every slash

The same path twice, in boxes 45mm wide. The first has no zero-width spaces and is cut wherever the line runs out. The second has one after every slash and breaks only there.

```
/usr/local/share/applications/  
documentation/reference/ma  
nual/index.html
```

```
/usr/local/share/applications/  
documentation/reference/  
manual/index.html
```

### No width of its own

Each pair of lines is the same word, drawn without and then with zero-width spaces inside it. Both lines of a pair have to be the same length and line up letter for letter.

```
Documentation  
Documentation
```

```
BoldItalicUnderlined  
BoldItalicUnderlined
```

```
UPPERCASE  
UPPERCASE
```

```
SMALL CAPITALS  
SMALL CAPITALS
```

## Justified text

A justified paragraph whose long compound words are joined by zero-width spaces. The spaces between words stretch, but a zero-width space never does, and the lines break at the zero-width spaces where a word would not fit.

The Donaudampfschiffahrtsgesellschaft ran steamers on the Danube, and its Kapitäns mützenabzeichenhersteller made the badges on the captains' caps, while the Rindfleisch etikettierungsüberwachungsaufgaben übertragungsgesetz governed the labelling of beef.

## Beside a soft hyphen and a no-break space

A soft hyphen draws a hyphen only where it breaks the line and a no-break space draws as a space that never breaks. Neither may be disturbed by a zero-width space next to it.

extraordinary  
circumstances

keep together  
keep together  
keep together

## In a table

The column is as wide as the widest of the words either side of each zero-width space. Measured as one run the text would be wider than the page, and the table would shrink it to fit.

|                                                                                                                              |                                |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| abcdefghijklabcdefghijklabcdefghijklabcdefghijklabcdefghijkl<br>abcdefghijklabcdefghijklabcdefghijklabcdefghijklabcdefghijkl | Eleven point<br>text beside it |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|

## In a list

- alphabetagammadelta  
  epsilonzetaetatheta
- iotakappalambdamunuxi  
  omicronpi

## Heading

The heading above holds a zero-width space. Its bookmark reads "Heading", with nothing between the two halves.

## A unit separator in the source

A U+001F is not the zero-width space that core-font text carries in its place: it is dropped, so it neither draws nor gives the line somewhere to break. The box is too narrow for the word, which is cut where the line runs out.

aaaabb  
bb

**In form fields**

Field text becomes the field's value, so a zero-width space is left out of it.

Secondchoice▼

Zerowidth

**Written directly**

Each line below is written straight to the page rather than through WriteHTML(). The watermark, WriteText(), WriteCell(), AutosizeText() and the shaded box draw no question mark; MultiCell() breaks at the zero-width spaces in a box 40mm wide; the SVG text and the text around the circle draw nothing between their halves.

WriteText

WriteCell, centred

MultiCellbreaksatevery  
zerowidthspace

AutosizeText

Shadedbox

SVGtext

CircularText

BottomText